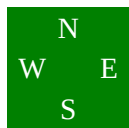


Board 2

North Deals
None Vul

♠ Q J 9 4
♥ K Q 10 7
♦ J 10 8 2
♣ 9

♠ A 8 5 3
♥ A 6 4 2
♦ K 7
♣ A K 5



♠ K
♥ J 9 8 3
♦ Q 9 5 4 3
♣ 6 4 2

♠ 10 7 6 2
♥ 5
♦ A 6
♣ Q J 10 8 7 3

West	North	East	South
	1 ♣	Pass	1 ♠
Pass	3 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			

4 ♠ by South
pull trumps. You win the ♥ A and play the ♠ A. East plays the ♠ K!

Do you change your Plan? Click?

Do you change your **PLAN**?

Well, East may be false-carding. He may also have the ♠ Q for example. But if you decide to play another trump and it turns out he was NOT false-carding you will be dead in the water. West will take his three trump tricks and some ♥s. Many ♥s.

So don't take the chance. Abandon trumps and start playing ♣ winners. Let West take the three trumps whenever he wants to. You will not lose control of the hand and will make your 10 tricks.

The risk of leading a second trump was too great.

As you see, West would have pulled your and dummy's trumps and then won 3 ♥ tricks.

A slightly different Plan would also have worked. At trick two you could have played a low trump from both hands. East would win the ♠ K, then probably play another ♥. You ruff, play a ♠ to the ♠ A and discover the split. From there the Plan is the same, play your ♣s and let West ruff when he wants.

Well, you're pretty sure you have a ♣ fit. But before you show partner your fine ♣ support you have an obligation to show a 4-card Major.

You respond 1 ♠, partner jumps to 3 ♠.

Your hand revalues to 11 or 12 points so you should bid game. 5 ♣ requires 11 tricks and 4 ♠ only 10 tricks. You bid 4 ♠.

South plays 4 ♠. West leads the ♥ K.

South plays 4 ♠. West leads the ♥ K.

Losers: ♠ 2 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 0 : ♣ 0 : Total = 2

You expect trumps to split 3-2 so you would lose 2 trumps. You have no other losers so you decide to

Board 4

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10

♥ Q J 10 2

♦ K 8

♣ 10 9 8 4 2

♠ 6 3

♥ 7 5 4

♦ 7 6 4

♣ A K Q J 7



♠ Q 9 5

♥ K 9 8 3

♦ Q J 9 5 3

♣ 6

♠ A K 8 7 4 2

♥ A 6

♦ A 10 2

♣ 5 3

West	North	East	South
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Pass	2♣	Pass	1♠
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Pass	4♠		3♠
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All Pass

4♠ by South

the ♣ suit without anyone trumping in.

Of course you open 1♠. Partner responds 2♣.

With 17 points and a 6-card suit you jump to 3♠.

Partner bids the game.

South plays 4♠. West leads the ♥Q.

South plays 4♠. West leads the ♥Q.

Losers: ♠ 1 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 0 : Total = 4

You have plenty of ♣ winners in dummy but you must be careful because there are no outside entries.

You win your ♥A and play ♠A and ♠K, both defenders following suit. The ♠Q is still out. To make sure you get to enjoy those ♣ winners you should continue with another ♠, forcing out the ♠Q. The defense will now take a ♥ if they are smart, but the rest of the tricks are yours because you can run

Think through what would have happened if you had not forced out the ♠Q.

East would have used his master ♠Q to ruff the second ♣, before you had taken any discards. You would still have to lose a ♥ and two ♦s.